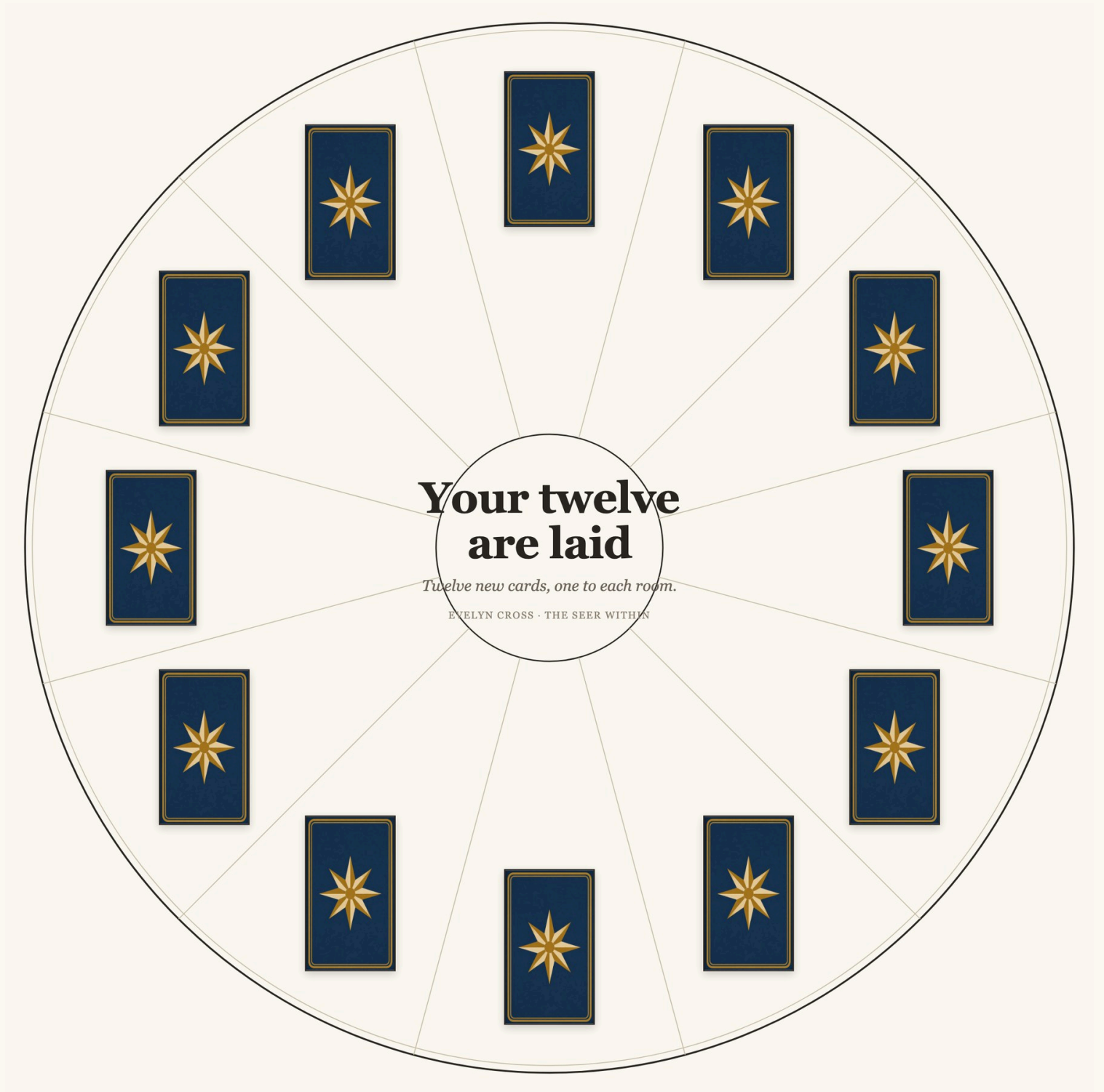




Laid for **Sarah** · 7 September 2026

YOUR TWELVE, AS THEY WERE LAID

- 1 yourself the Devil
- 2 what you own Strength
- 3 what you say, and who you say it to the High Priestess · reversed
- 4 home, and what you came from the Hierophant · reversed
- 5 romance, and what delights you Justice · reversed
- 6 work, health, the daily grind the Wheel of Fortune
- 7 who you are bound to Temperance · reversed
- 8 what is hidden, and what comes through others the Fool · reversed
- 9 what you believe the Hanged Man
- 10 your standing Judgment
- 11 your circle the Sun
- 12 what is being kept from you the Hermit

I laid your twelve last night, late, when the house had gone quiet enough that I could hear each card come down on the wood. Your reading came out of the trumps alone. That is the heaviest work I do, it costs me a whole night, and I keep it for the women whose first draw asks for it — yours asked.

Two of them pull against each other, and I saw it while they were still going down. The Wheel of Fortune in your sixth says movement is already under way and not by your hand. The Hanged Man in your ninth says you believe holding still is the honest way to be paid. I am not going to settle that here. The arrangement below settles it, and it does not settle it in the Hanged Man's favour.

This is a good draw, dear. Not a gentle one in every room, but a good one. The next two months are the window for all twelve, and no room below invents a clock of its own. Your life actually moves in three of them — your second, your fifth, your sixth. Money through your own hands. An arrival. And the ordinary week that turns out to be the door for both.

Four rooms carry what you were owed. Your second and your eighth hold the two windfalls, and each names the door its own comes through. Your fifth separates the two readings I refused to choose between. Your twelfth names the person the Tower meant. That is what you paid for, and each answer stands in its own house below.

Whatever you had to admit to yourself before you paid me — set it down now. Nobody reads her own house from inside it.

One thing before you start. Some of this will look as though it argues with itself — ease offered in one room, work asked for in the next. Read all twelve before you decide what they say. The meaning is in the arrangement, and no life is consistent either.

HOUSE 1

yourself

The cosmos has guided your choice to the Devil, a card of a bargain you keep choosing



THE DEVIL

He crouches on a black half-block, wings folded like a bat's, one hand raised as if to bless and the other lowered — and in the lowered hand a lit torch, held pointing at the floor, warming nothing. Nothing on that block is moving. That is the trouble with it.

This card is not calling you weak, and it is not calling you a fool. It is showing an arrangement you get something real out of. Comfort. Quiet. The relief of not having to decide. It holds because it pays you.

Between the horns sits a star set upside down, above the eyes. The thinking is inverted, dear. You have made the smaller life sound like the sensible one.

Left exactly as it stands, it goes on taking the same thing it has been taking — your appetite, and your say in what comes next.

what you own

The celestial wisdom has guided your selection to **Strength**, a card of holding what you already have



STRENGTH

Above her head a small figure of eight lies on its side, floating loose — not painted on her, not held, just turning there while she works. Nothing else in that sky. Behind her one grey hill, and no road drawn to it.

The money in this room comes through your own hands, and through something already in your name. Not a stranger, not a letter. Someone else puts a figure on a thing you own and the figure is larger than the one you have been carrying. That is how you will know it — the number arrives in another person's mouth.

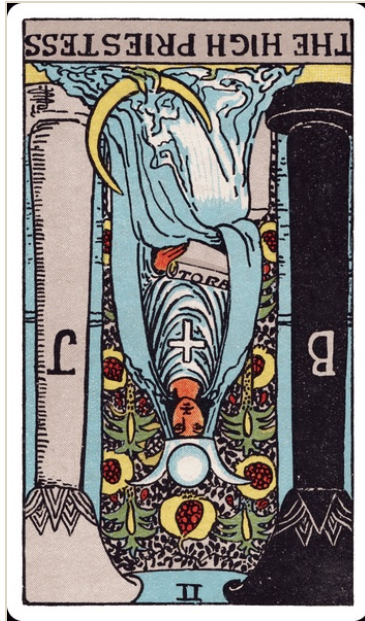
The Wheel of Fortune stands in your sixth, the room of ordinary working days. So the door is the week you already keep.

Your part is the lion. The sum you name when asked what you can afford. The thing you would sell last. The payment you have never queried.

It comes because you held on, dear, and it stays only while your hands stay where they are.

what you say, and who you say it to

The cosmic alignment has guided your choice to the High Priestess, a card of the answer you already have



THE HIGH PRIESTESS ·
REVERSED

Her robe runs off the bottom edge and turns to water there, and the seam is nowhere to be found. Cloth, then sea. Nothing on her marks where the one stops being the other.

Your silence has gone the same way. It began as discretion and became the floor you stand on.

You know the answer, dear. You have known it a while, and you have said it to yourself in better words than you will manage out loud.

The person it concerns has not heard one of those words. They cannot answer a thing that was never put to them — so nothing has moved, and you have taken that stillness for their reply.

This card hands you the conversation, provided you open it yourself. Out loud, this month, to the one it belongs to. Not to a friend as a rehearsal.

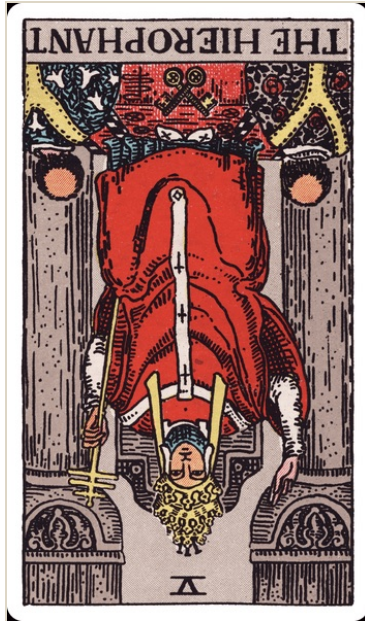
Behind her the cloth of pomegranates hangs closed across the gap between the two pillars. Nothing passes it while it hangs.

Where did you learn to keep quiet like that, so early and so well? The fourth house had it waiting for you before you could speak.

HOUSE 4

home, and what you came from

Your choice has been guided to the Hierophant, a card of approval never given



THE HIEROPHANT · REVERSED

He holds the staff in his left hand — three crossbars on it, the top one shortest, narrowing as it climbs. It is a ladder of rank. Nothing about it is his; it was handed down to him and he holds it for the next one.

Three crossbars. Three tiers on the crown. Everything in the house you came from was built to reach you in stages, and the stages stopped short.

The proper form was there for you. It did not happen. Whether you would not stand up for it or it was never held out to you, the result on the table is the same.

You live outside that structure and you are still being priced by it. That is what you inherited, dear, and never chose — the measuring, kept on long after the thing being measured was

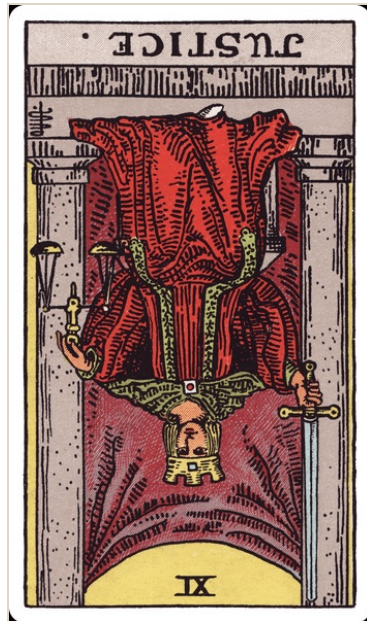
let go.

Below him two men kneel, heads bare. You are not one of them.

You decided that years ago. You stopped going back to ask for the blessing, and you have not asked since.

romance, and what delights you

The cosmic forces have guided your selection to Justice, a verdict that has not come back yet



JUSTICE · REVERSED

Her eyes are open and looking straight out of the card, past you — not down at the scales she is holding. She is not reading a result. She is waiting to be handed one.

That is where your romance sits. Something about you is being weighed elsewhere, slowly, and no one will tell you when.

There is no renewal available to hand you. Temperance stands reversed in your seventh, the room of who you are bound to; the pouring there has stopped mid-stream. What has stopped cannot be revived and given back.

So it is an arrival. Your twin flame, dear — and not a stranger. You already know his name.

The second week of March. I can date this one room and no other because an arrival is an event, and events land on a day.

The other eleven are weather.

He will be mid-errand, moving with purpose, not looking for you. You are on the way. He stops.

Arriving and being recognised are two different days. Women miss theirs braced for the wrong one.

Who came into your mind just now?

work, health, the daily grind

Your choice fell on the Wheel of Fortune, a turn that comes from outside



THE WHEEL OF FORTUNE

The sphinx sits at the very top of the wheel, quite still, with a sword laid flat across it. Everything else on that card is travelling. The snake slides down the left side head first, the dog-headed figure climbs the right, and the sphinx neither rises nor falls. It only keeps the sword.

Your working week is about to be turned by a hand that is not yours.

You have already half-noticed it, dear. Something in the ordinary run of your days has been shifting position, and you put it down to tiredness and let it go.

It was not tiredness. It was the wheel beginning to move.

The figure another person names over the thing you own — Strength, in your second — reaches you through this week and no other. So the week is not the drudgery you take it for. It is the door.

Your body carries the turn. Feed it this month.

Letters run right round that rim, spaced apart, and no hand is holding the wheel up.

The wheel turns whether or not the rest of your house is in order. And one thing in your house is not in order at all.

who you are bound to

Your choice has fallen on Temperance, a blending hurried past its season



TEMPERANCE · REVERSED

One bare foot stands in the pool, the other flat on the bank, and neither has shifted for the whole of the pouring. The yellow flowers grow close by that standing foot, in wet ground, at their own rate.

Your bond has been given no such patience. You have been hurrying it — asking it to come right at once instead of by degrees.

So the proportions keep landing wrong. Too much of you, then too little, then too much again. That is not a flaw in your temper, dear. It is time you have not allowed.

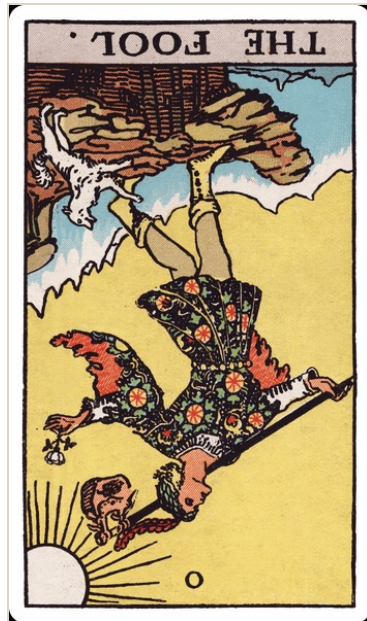
Look at how the water crosses the gap: a stream that does not fall straight down. At that angle it can only move slowly.

Taken as news that will settle itself, the correcting simply goes on — and it is the correcting, not the bond, that makes the whole thing look unsteady to the one you are tied to.

Stop mending it. This week, give it nothing — no fresh offer, no withdrawal.

what is hidden, and what comes through others

The cosmos has turned your hand to the Fool, a card of the beginning you declined



THE FOOL · REVERSED

His face is tilted up and off the ground entirely, so the only thing in his eyeline is empty air above the snow. The pale sun sits behind him, low and wide, lighting none of it. What he needs to see is nowhere he is looking.

A beginning was genuinely held out to you and you let it go by. You have called that the sensible choice ever since.

It is not charging you with cowardice, dear. It is showing that the opening was real, and that it did not close when you walked past it.

Which is where your second windfall comes from. Somebody else stepped where you did not, and money off that step reaches you through their hands — settled in a room you are not sitting in. Judgment stands in your tenth: you hear it

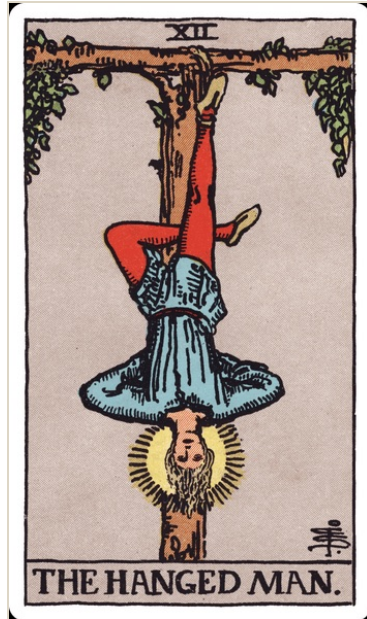
announced, already decided.

It changes your love life rather than your bank balance because it buys you your own footing. The man in your fifth meets a woman who needs nothing from him.

Leave this room as it stands and the sum arrives and vanishes into the arrangement you already keep. It purchases more of the same life.

what you believe

The celestial wisdom has guided your selection to the Hanged Man, a card of waiting you chose yourself



THE HANGED MAN

The beam he hangs from is alive. Small green leaves are coming out of the wood while he stays perfectly still — the only growing thing in the picture, and it is not him.

He tied that rope. One ankle, his own knot, his hands behind his back where nobody can see them.

You believe that enduring quietly is the honest way to be paid. That if you stay steady long enough, the right people notice and the thing comes to you. You would not defend that out loud. It runs you anyway.

You can point at it, dear. The answer you give when someone asks why you have not moved on it yet. The outcome you call realistic. What you quietly think of people who ask outright for what they want.

That belief is what feeds the Devil in your first house — it gives the arrangement a respectable name.

The ring of light is already round his head. He has been paid; go on hanging past it and you lose what the seeing was for.

So the belief is about to be proved wrong on its own terms. You are going to be noticed, and not for the waiting — and the noticing will not do your talking for you.

your standing

Your choice has led you to Judgment, a card of being named in the open



JUDGMENT

A square flag hangs off the trumpet — white, with a red cross running to all four edges, held out flat by the same breath that sounds the horn. It is a standard. Whoever carries it is declaring themselves in front of everyone present.

Work of yours is about to be named aloud. Something you did and were never credited for surfaces with your name on it, and it arrives all at once — not as a rumour that gathers.

You will be asked to speak to it. That is your whole part in it.

This card hands you your standing back, provided you claim the work as yours the moment it is put to you. Plainly, dear. No qualifying it, no passing the credit sideways to seem gracious. Do that this month.

The child in the middle stands with its back to us, arms straight out from the shoulders, already risen. It is not waiting to be told it may.

your circle

Your selection has fallen to the Sun



THE SUN

The child rides out ahead of the wall with nothing on — no saddle, no reins, no bridle in either hand, both arms wide open. Riding like that in front of people is a decision.

Your circle sees you more plainly than you think. Not the version you present. You.

Four sunflowers stand above that wall, heads up over the top. Four. That is the size of what is actually yours here — not the whole list of names, four people who have been watching you at your worst and stayed turned toward you.

The red flag streams out sideways from the pole in the child's hand. Warmth reaches you from the ones who make no secret of it, and you will not have to interpret a single thing they do.

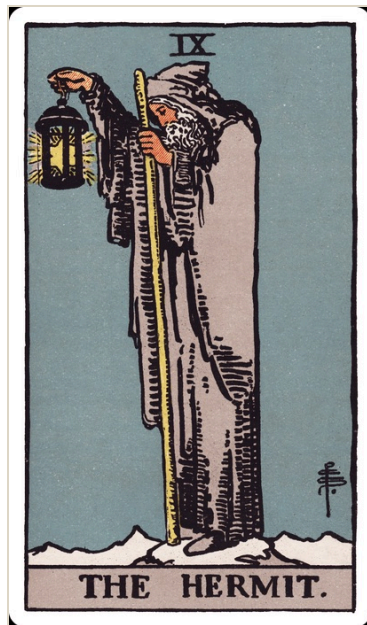
The quiet ones are not the mystery, dear. Their silence is as plain as the rest of it.

And you already stopped auditioning for them. You made that choice a while ago — keep it.

Four people turned toward you with nothing to decode. Hold that steady through the last room, because the last room is the one whose quiet is not plain.

what is being kept from you

And your twelfth card is the Hermit, a card of slow deliberate looking



THE HERMIT

Nothing stands behind him but sky. No path was drawn up to that peak and none drawn down again — so the climbing is not on the card, and neither is the way out.

What is being kept from you is not far away. It is in your own house, and it is a person still in it.

Not somebody from before. Temperance stands reversed in your seventh, and the pouring there has stopped mid-stream — one of you is still holding a cup out and it is you. That is not a bond being hurried by two. That is one hand withdrawing.

It has already begun, dear. No one else can see it yet. It lives in things quietly discontinued, never announced.

The lamp shows one step of ground. So stop reading his words and start counting what he no longer does.

What has he stopped doing that he never told you he had stopped?

—

Together the twelve say a thing none of them says alone. Both windfalls reach you by somebody else's decision: a figure in another mouth, a step a person took where you did not. Neither waits on your permission. What they want is somewhere to land that is not the arrangement crouching in your first house.

The order runs like this. Your twelfth is already moving, and it is the condition of your fifth — you cannot recognise a man arriving while your hand is still held out to one that has gone. Your second comes through your sixth. If the second runs late, the fifth does not; the arrival keeps its own day regardless.

Your eighth put that man plainly, before you got to him: he meets a woman who needs nothing from him. Two rooms, one man, and I did not arrange them.

And you stop hearing everything last, dear. You will see what is being quietly dropped before anybody announces it, and you will know the number before it is offered to you.

Inside five to seven days, someone says a figure out loud about something in your name — in passing, not as an offer. Write down who said it.

I dated one room and one only: your fifth, the answer about the Lovers, because an arrival is an event and events land on a day. The rest I have not dated and I will not pretend I can. Two months is when the movement starts, not when all of it is finished. Some rooms will have opened inside a fortnight; the slow ones are slow because of the card standing in them, and a woman who reads slow as failure walks off just before it comes right.

This week, before anything else here: open your mouth to the person in your third house.

And now the second part, dear — this one is yours to keep

When you have read your twelve properly — all of them, more than once — there is a second thing I want to give you, and it costs you nothing but a minute a night.

I said in my letter that the difference is not whether things happen to you. It is whether they happen to you from behind.

This is the practice that makes the difference. It is the only one I give away.

What it is

Twenty-eight nights. One line a night. That is the whole of it.

Each night before you sleep, you write down **one thing you noticed that day that was different from the day before.**

Not how you felt. Not what you hope. What you *noticed*. Something someone said that they don't usually say. A message that came at an odd hour. A silence where there is normally noise. The way a room went when you walked into it.

One line. Ordinary handwriting, ordinary paper, no ceremony. If nothing was different, write *nothing was different* — that is a real entry and you will want it later.

The reason is simple and it is not mystical, dear. Your twelfth house is holding something unsaid, and things like that are never invisible. They are only ever *unrecorded*. A woman notices eleven small wrong notes across a fortnight, forgets ten of them, and is genuinely astonished by the eleventh. She was told eleven times. She just had nowhere to put it.

The ledger is somewhere to put it.

The four turns

Nights 1 to 7 — the first turn. Just notice. Don't interpret, don't join anything up, and above all don't act on it. This week you are only training the eye. Write the line and close the book.

Your reading said the first sign shows itself inside five to seven days. It lands in this turn. You will not necessarily know it when it arrives — that is exactly why you are writing it down.

Nights 8 to 14 — the second turn. Same one line, and add a second only when you genuinely have one. By now you will start wanting to explain what you're writing. Resist it for

one more week. An explanation written the same night is almost always the explanation you already believed that morning.

Night 15 — the read-back. This is the night the practice pays. Do not write anything first. Sit down and read your fourteen lines in one sitting, in order, start to finish.

Something will come up off the page that was not visible on any single night. It always does. That is the whole reason for the fourteen — not one of those lines is worth much alone and together they are a pattern.

Then write your line for the fifteenth night, and write underneath it what you saw in the fourteen.

Nights 15 to 21 — the third turn. Now you know what you have been noticing, so notice *that*. Your attention has something to point at, and you will find you catch things on the day now instead of three days late.

Nights 22 to 28 — the fourth turn. Keep writing, and this week let yourself act on what you have found. Ask the question. Decline the thing. Say the sentence you have been keeping. You have three weeks of evidence behind you and you are no longer guessing.

On the twenty-eighth night, read the whole ledger through.

The two love weeks

In the weeks your reading named, pay particular attention to the people you come across.

Your fifth house has something already in motion toward you, and your reading has said in its own room whether it arrives as a stranger or as someone already in the frame. Either way it comes in small — which is precisely the kind of thing the eye skips and the ledger catches.

Someone you know may reappear in these weeks. Someone in the frame may step forward in it. Write it down on the night, in the ordinary way, even when it seems far too small to mean anything.

Especially then. The ones that matter almost always look too small on the night.

If nothing happens

Then you run the twenty-eight again.

I mean that plainly and not as a consolation. Some women's first cycle is all noise — four weeks of *nothing was different* — and their second cycle is the one that shows the shape. The practice is not a spell that either works or doesn't. It is an eye being trained, and eyes take a while.

The second twenty-eight is easier than the first, and it is the one where the read-back on the fifteenth night stops you cold.

And that is the gift

Keep the book. Not for me — I don't want to see it, and I'd rather you wrote freely than wrote something you'd be willing to show a reader.

Keep it because in eight weeks you are going to want to know whether you saw it coming.

You did. It will be on the page in your own handwriting, three weeks before it happened, in a line you thought was too small to matter.

That is what it is to stop finding out last.

These twelve were laid for you and for nobody else. The writing is assisted — I use a machine to help me put a reading into words. The draw is real and it is yours.

Evelyn